Strategic report

Chief Executive's review

The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders.

Company financial statements

Balance sheet

As at 31 March 2025

	Notes	2025 £m	2024 £m
Non-current assets			
Investments in subsidiaries	3	5,210	5,210
Current assets			
Amounts owed by group undertakings	4	1,020	998
Cash at bank		15	12
		1,035	1,010
Current liabilities			
Amounts owed to group undertakings	5	(400)	(390)
		(400)	(390)
Net current assets		635	620
Net assets		**5,845**	**5,830**
Equity			
Called up share capital	6	100	100
Retained earnings		5,745	5,730
Total equity		**5,845**	**5,830**

Consolidated financial statements

Consolidated income statement

For the year ended 31 March 2025

	Notes	2025 £m	2024 £m
Revenue	2	12,500	11,800
Cost of sales		(8,750)	(8,300)
Gross profit		3,750	3,500
Administrative expenses	3	(2,150)	(2,020)
Operating profit	3	1,600	1,480
Finance income	5	40	25
Finance costs	5	(190)	(175)
Profit before taxation		1,450	1,330
Taxation	6	(363)	(333)
Profit for the year		**1,087**	**997**

Consolidated financial statements

Consolidated balance sheet

As at 31 March 2025

	Notes	2025 £m	2024 £m
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	10	6,000	5,800
Right-of-use assets	11	1,200	1,150
Intangible assets	12	800	820
		8,000	7,770
Current assets			
Inventories	14	1,100	1,050
Trade and other receivables	15	700	680
Cash and cash equivalents	16	900	770
		2,700	2,500
Total assets		**10,700**	**10,270**
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	17	(2,400)	(2,300)
Borrowings	18	(300)	(250)
Lease liabilities	19	(150)	(140)
		(2,850)	(2,690)
Non-current liabilities			
Borrowings	18	(2,500)	(2,600)
Lease liabilities	19	(1,100)	(1,080)
		(3,600)	(3,680)
Net assets		**4,250**	**3,900**
Equity			
Share capital	20	250	250
Retained earnings		4,000	3,650
Total equity		**4,250**	**3,900**

Notes to the consolidated financial statements

The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders.